

ABC Healthcare Services

REMOTE WORK POLICY

Information Security Governance Program

Field	Details
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1.0	June 1, 2026	Initial Release	Information Security Manager

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Remote Work Policy is to establish security requirements and responsibilities for employees, contractors, consultants, and authorized personnel who perform work outside organizational facilities. This policy ensures that organizational information, systems, and assets remain protected while supporting flexible work arrangements and business continuity objectives.

Risk Statement

Failure to follow secure remote working practices may result in unauthorized access, data breaches, malware infections, information leakage, financial losses, regulatory violations, operational disruption, and reputational damage.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, temporary personnel, vendors, and authorized users who access ABC Healthcare Services information systems while working remotely. The policy applies to company-owned devices, approved personal devices, cloud services, applications, networks, and information assets.

3. Policy Objectives

- Protect organizational information while working remotely.
- Establish secure remote access requirements.
- Reduce cybersecurity and operational risks.
- Support regulatory and compliance obligations.
- Improve employee accountability and awareness.
- Maintain the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information assets.
- Strengthen organizational resilience and business continuity.

4. Approved Remote Work Arrangements

Remote work may be performed from:

- Home offices
- Client locations
- Approved temporary work locations
- Business travel locations

Remote work must not be conducted from locations that present unacceptable security risks.

Employee eligibility for remote work shall be determined by management and business requirements.

5. Device Security Requirements

Remote workers must ensure that all approved devices comply with organizational security requirements.

Security Requirements

- Devices must be password protected.
- Device encryption must be enabled.
- Antivirus software must be installed and updated.
- Operating systems must be regularly patched.
- Firewalls must remain enabled.
- Devices must be physically secured when unattended.

Approved Devices

Device Type	Approved
Company Laptop	Yes
Company Mobile Device	Yes
Approved Personal Device	Yes
Public Shared Computer	No

6. Remote Access Requirements

All remote access connections must comply with organizational security standards.

Requirements include:

- VPN usage is mandatory.
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is required.
- Secure communication channels must be used.
- Remote sessions may be monitored and logged.
- Users must access only approved systems.

Mandatory Security Controls

Control	Requirement
VPN	Required
MFA	Required
Device Encryption	Required
Endpoint Protection	Required
Screen Lock	Required

7. Public Wi-Fi Usage

Public Wi-Fi networks present increased security risks.

When public Wi-Fi usage is unavoidable:

- VPN must be enabled.
- MFA must be enabled.
- Sensitive information should not be downloaded unnecessarily.
- Users must verify network legitimacy.
- File sharing must be disabled.

Open public networks must not be used for accessing highly sensitive information.

8. Data Protection Requirements

Remote workers must comply with the Data Classification Policy at all times.

Requirements include:

- Protecting confidential information from unauthorized viewing.
- Using approved storage locations.

- Avoiding storage of sensitive data on unapproved devices.
- Encrypting sensitive information where required.
- Following information handling requirements.

Sensitive Information Examples

- Customer information
- Personal information
- Financial records
- Employee records
- Medical information
- Security reports

9. Physical Security Requirements

Remote workers are responsible for protecting company assets and information.

Requirements include:

- Locking screens whenever devices are unattended.
- Securing devices in locked locations.
- Preventing unauthorized access by visitors.
- Protecting printed documents.
- Reporting lost or stolen devices immediately.

10. Incident Reporting Requirements

Remote workers must immediately report:

- Lost or stolen devices
- Malware infections
- Unauthorized access attempts
- Phishing attacks
- Data leakage incidents
- Security policy violations

Reporting Timeline

Critical incidents must be reported within **1 Hour**

Lost devices must be reported immediately upon discovery.

11. User Responsibilities

Remote Workers

Remote workers are responsible for:

- Following security policies.
- Protecting authentication credentials.
- Maintaining device security.
- Reporting incidents promptly.
- Completing security awareness training.

Managers

Managers are responsible for:

- Reviewing remote work requests.
- Ensuring compliance with policy requirements.
- Escalating security concerns.
- Supporting employee awareness.

Information Security Team

Responsible for:

- Monitoring compliance.
- Providing guidance and support.
- Conducting security reviews.
- Investigating policy violations.

12. Security Awareness Requirements

All remote workers must complete annual security awareness training covering:

- Remote work security
- Phishing awareness
- Social engineering
- Password security
- Data protection
- Incident reporting

Training Completion Target

100%

13. Compliance Monitoring

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Metric	Target
MFA Adoption	100%
VPN Compliance	100%
Device Encryption Compliance	100%
Security Awareness Completion	100%
Incident Reporting Compliance	100%
Remote Access Review Completion	100%

Sample Compliance Dashboard

Control	Result
MFA Adoption	100%
VPN Usage	99%
Device Encryption	100%
Security Training Completion	98%
Incident Reporting Compliance	100%
Remote Access Reviews	100%

14. Policy Violations

Failure to comply with this policy may result in:

- Verbal warning
- Written warning
- Suspension of remote work privileges
- Suspension of access privileges
- Disciplinary action
- Employment termination
- Legal action where applicable

All violations shall be investigated by the Information Security Team.

15. Policy Exceptions

Requests for policy exceptions must include:

- Business justification
- Risk assessment
- Management approval
- Information Security approval
- Compensating controls
- Defined expiration date

All approved exceptions shall be documented and reviewed annually.

16. Conclusion

ABC Healthcare Services recognizes the importance of secure remote working practices in protecting organizational information and supporting business operations. Compliance with this policy ensures that remote workers maintain appropriate security controls while accessing organizational systems from outside corporate facilities, thereby reducing organizational risk and supporting business continuity objectives.

17. References

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022
- NIST Cybersecurity Framework
- CIS Critical Security Controls
- Data Classification Policy
- Access Control Policy
- Incident Response Policy

18. Document Control

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